



The Samsung LA22A480

is a 22-inch LCD TV that comes with an FM tuner and sells for Rs. 20,900



Hitachi UT42-MX700A

Hitachi UT42-MX700A: Ultra slim

This display's main claim to designer fame is the fact that it is only 1.5-inches thick. We measured this advertised feature and it is accurate. Although the display is not lighter than others in the same size category the drastically slimmer design mean that it is often less than 50 per cent of the thickness of other 42-inch displays. The bezel is also very slim and a translucent, glossy-black. The silver stand is also pretty compact and these two colours interact to create a starkly attractive look.

The colours on this display are realistic without being oversaturated and unrealistically vibrant. The contrast is a little deficient. This is noticeable in certain scenes involving a lot of intensity-variation in the same colour, for example clouds with varying intensities of white, or the sky. In such images slight banding is noticeable. There is also noticeable artifacting that happens with certain non-native resolution videos. In fact this display did very poorly in the grey-scale check that is a good indication of the contrast ratio of a display. Even the Spyder showed this displays true contrast ratio to be in the region of 400:1 — this is not good enough. One saving grace was the fact that it did very well with text and fonts appear very clear and crisp. At Rs 1,35,00 the UT42-MX700A does not present a strong enough case for itself to warrant a recommendation from us.

Panasonic Viera TH-42PV80D: Viera - the new synonym for value

Panasonic's TH-42PV80D is a 42-inch plasma display. It has a very neat look with no real standout attributes but everything looks put together well and with care. The front is finished in a smooth glossy black and the bezel isn't too wide — it's a suave looking display that will subtly attract attention. And it's built very well too. We were surprised to find a n SD memory card slot integrated into the front bezel and recessed under a cleverly designed, flush fitting tray that opens outwards. This means you can now access images taken with your camera by simply the card into the SD/MMC slot and view your images at a resolution of 1080p! There is also

a USB connect on the side of the display. The front panel also features an HDMI port and one composite connect.

This is a great display with a superb contrast and great colours. Once calibrated, we could not see any issues with colour or contrast 95 percent of the time. In fact our 1080p clips have not looked this good too often and there is absolutely no deficiency in the contrast that is noticeable by the naked eye. Colours are rich and vibrant but not unrealistically so and everything on-screen has a very life-like look to the colours. It's a superb display for movies and gaming of any sort. A pity that its text rendition using HDMI connectivity is not as good and text looks a little blurry around the edges and all fonts are rendered as well as



Panasonic Viera TH-42PV80D

we'd like. Hooking up this display via D-Sub reduced the issue with text to a great degree but doing this means going without the wonder of 1080p or 1080i — since 1920 x 1080 de-interlaced/progressive scanned is not supported via D-Sub connectivity.

The price of the Viera TH-42PV80D is the killer — Rs 64,900 for a 42-inch display is good by anyone's standards and superb for a really quality display. In fact so impressed were the lot of us, that we awarded it our Digit Editor's Choice. If you're looking for excellent value for money and want something in the region of 42-inches for movie watching or gaming — this is the one to get.



LG 42PG61UR-80R

LG 42PG61UR-80R: Smooth Operator

LGs 42-inch plasma offering looks radically different from their 42-inch LCD we tested. For one the screen and bezel are one integrated unit and without the display turned on its difficult to tell the bezel apart from the actual screen because when the display is off the colour of the bezel and screen match. However, when the display is turned on we noticed the bezel was a little thicker than we would like and this makes the unit unnecessarily bulky. The remote unit is identical to the one bundled with the other LG display we tested. Upon turning on the display imagine our shock when we realised that its native resolution is 1024 x 768 progressive scanned pixels. 1080p is a selectable resolution but it messes up text quite a lot to the point that you wouldn't want to use this resolution. This clearly indicates that this display is aimed at corporate users who will not be interested in HD-resolutions that are typically meant for the movie watchers.

Upon calibration the whites had a yellowish tinge to them and we repeated the calibration process. Everything went off without a glitch the second time round although text had a noticeably stretched look to it; presumably because this is a wide-screen display that does not run at a widescreen resolution. Even Display Mate had its share of complaints with the 42PG61UR-80R — there was an issue with the rendition of red and green in the colour tests and moiré was noticeable. Even movies were not as impressive as they could be mainly because of the resolution of the display. There are also the ugly black bands on the top and bottom of the screen when working with HD-content because of the aspect ratio mismatch. Priced at Rs 62,000 this would have been the ideal display for the value oriented user looking at a 42-inch display but not with its rather low level of performance. As it stands we'd recommend the LG 42-LG80FR over this one — the fact that this one is a whopping Rs 21,000 cheaper notwithstanding.

Sharp Aquos LC-37A65M: True beauty is superficial

The 37-inch Aquos is a real beauty. It is built around a glossy LCD panel that has adequate surface treatment to avoid unnecessary reflections. The speakers are beautifully made and occupy an entire strip at the bottom. Finished in steel-grey these are placed angled inwards, so as to give them a slightly recessed look. The entire bezel is black and the finish is smooth and glossy. Separating the black bezel and the bottom mounted steel-grey speakers is a curved strip of fibre that is finished in high-